



Research and share information on indigenous cultures

D2.TTG.CL3.18

Trainee Manual



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainee chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Research and share information on indigenous cultures

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Research and share information on indigenous cultures in a range of settings within the travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TTG.CL3.18

Nominal Hours:

90

Element 1: Research information on indigenous cultures

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify sources of information on indigenous cultures
- 1.2 Research and interpret sources of information
- 1.3 Demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture(s)
- 1.4 Determine how information on indigenous cultures should be used

Element 2: Share information on indigenous cultures

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Communicate general knowledge to colleagues
- 2.2 Use indigenous guides and/or interpreters where possible
- 2.3 Brief tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with indigenous people
- 2.4 Communicate general knowledge to tour groups
- 2.5 Reply to tour group questions on indigenous cultures
- 2.6 Monitor and respond to culturally inappropriate behaviour

Element 3: Maintain contact with local communities

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Liaise with local communities to identify and respond to changed circumstances
- 3.2 Modify information provided in accordance with issues raised by the local community

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Research information on indigenous cultures				
1.1	Identify sources of information on indigenous cultures	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Research and interpret sources of information	1.1	3 – 10	2
1.3	Demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture(s)	1.1	11, 12, 13	3
1.4	Determine how information on indigenous cultures should be used	1.1	14, 15	4
Element 2: Share information on indigenous cultures				
2.1	Communicate general knowledge to colleagues	2.1	16, 17, 18	5
2.2	Use indigenous guides and/or interpreters where possible	2.1	19 – 22	6
2.3	Brief tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with indigenous people	2.1	23 – 26	7
2.4	Communicate general knowledge to tour groups	2.1	27 – 30	8
2.5	Reply to tour group questions on indigenous cultures	2.1	31, 32, 33	9
2.6	Monitor and respond to culturally inappropriate behaviour	2.1	34, 35, 36	10

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 3: Maintain contact with local communities				
3.1	Liaise with local communities to identify and respond to changed circumstances	3.1	37, 38	11
3.2	Modify information provided in accordance with issues raised by the local community	3.1	39, 40, 41	12

Glossary

Term	Explanation
Anthropology	Study of people historically to present day
Culture/s	The socially constructed and learned ways of behaving and believing that identify individual and distinct social groups
Curator	Manage/keeper/person-in-charge of (for example) museum or gallery
Desk-top research	A generic term for secondary research done 'in the office': reading books/materials; using the internet to search for information
Inclusions	Things 'included' in a tour – they may be side tours, merchandise, meals and/or refreshments, photographs, activities
Indigenous	People native to a particular country
Indigenous cultures	Relate to local indigenous communities which may include any community that is in the vicinity of a tour group while the tour is being conducted
Itinerary	A schedule for a tour showing what tour group members will be doing, where they will be going, and the times for each activity
Q&A session	Question and Answer session
Scripted commentary	A prepared talk about an identified topic/topics of interest to a tour group
Tour schedule	List showing times and dates of tours to target destinations
Unscripted commentary	Comments made by Tour Guides to respond to questions and situations arising on a tour: used to support scripted commentary
Veracity	Truth/honesty
Veto	Ban/prohibit

Element 1:

Research information on indigenous cultures

1.1 Identify sources of information on indigenous cultures

Introduction

An essential first step in researching information on indigenous cultures is to identify the realistic sources of information that exist for those cultures/communities.

This section presents and explains essential terminology relevant to this unit and identifies and discusses a range of possible information sources.

Essential terminology

It is useful to begin by addressing several commonly used terms which are central to the essence of this unit.

Note:

- Different business/operators may have their own interpretations of these terms – so it is important to determine definitions as they apply and as they are used in individual organisations
- There is always a need to determine the countries, cultures and communities a Tour Operator wants to investigate – because all research needs to have a specific target.



Indigenous

There is sometimes confusion about exactly what the term 'indigenous' means.

In reality it has a very straight-forward definition.

It simply means people who are native to a particular country.

The term is synonymous with the 'aboriginal' people of a country.

Culture/s

In the context of this unit culture/s can be seen as:

- The socially constructed and learned ways of behaving and believing that identify individual and distinct social groups such as an indigenous community
- The beliefs, values, knowledge, assumptions, experiences and ideas which form the basis of the way a community thinks, lives and acts

- The suite of customs, rituals, symbology, myth and legend of the people in the community
- Being transmitted/passed on to other generations through a combination of oral communication and writing (language), art (such as music, song, story-telling, painting and dance) and the institutionalisation of key aspects of the community (as this relates, for example, to social activity, economics, politics, agriculture and farming, industrialisation, laws and justice, security, health, the environment, education and religion).

Indigenous culture

Indigenous culture is the term used to describe the totality of characteristics which exist within a nominated country or community and differentiate one country or community from others.

In practice:

- There is commonly variations between the cultures of different countries – despite there often being several points of similarity
- Different cultures can exist within different communities/groups within the same nation/country
- Cultures of countries and communities evolve over time as they change to accommodate internal events and external pressures
- Countries and communities are proud and protective of their culture – regardless of how different they may be to the cultures of other countries and communities
- Enterprises (such as Tour Operators) are increasingly aware of:
 - The commercial value of different indigenous cultures
 - The need to research and share information on indigenous cultures in a respectful and sensitive manner.



Local indigenous communities

Local indigenous communities may include any community that is in the vicinity of a tour group while the tour is being conducted.

The community may be:

- Domestic or foreign
- Small or large
- Nearby or remote
- Developed or undeveloped.



Cultural sites

Cultural sites may include but are not limited to:

- Towns/villages
- Individual homes and/or buildings
- Significant sites – as defined by the local community
- Galleries
- Cultural centres
- Ceremonies
- activities
- Natural sites.



Websites

For more detail regarding culture/s visit:

http://www.iwgia.org/iwgia_files_publications_files/0511_ASEAN_BRIEFING_PAPER_eb.pdf - ASEAN'S Indigenous peoples

<http://www.austlii.edu.au/au/journals/ILB/2013/1.pdf> - The ASEAN Human Rights Declaration and Indigenous Rights

http://www.iwgia.org/iwgia_files_publications_files/0657_indigenous_peoples_and_corporate_accountability_in_the_ASEAN_compressed.pdf - Indigenous people's and corporate accountability in the ASEAN: a report of the Asia Indigenous Peoples Pact

<http://rio20.net/en/propuestas/statement-of-indigenous-peoples-and-ethnic-minorities-of-asean/> - Statement of Indigenous Peoples and Ethnic Minorities of ASEAN.

Possible sources of information

Generically, commonly used and effective sources of information for research on indigenous cultures will be related to:

- Printed material – such as:
 - Books – which will include:
 - Travel guides for the country in question
 - Literature/texts on nominated countries and communities
 - Magazines
 - Advertising brochures and promotional materials
- The general media – domestic and as available in target destinations/communities (see next section)
- Relevant people from identified communities – such as:
 - The people of different cultures
 - Elders
 - Key individuals from within the community with specialist knowledge/expertise

- Community leaders within various cultures
- Families
- Story-tellers
- Industry personnel – such as:
 - Other Tour Guides with specialised knowledge of different peoples and cultures
 - Representatives from peak industry bodies – who often have a database of relevant information or who can provide the names of people who can be valuable sources
 - Officers from the government bodies who have responsibility for Tourism, Culture, Trade or other related/associated matters
 - Staff working in Visitor Information Centres of target countries/communities (where these exist) – as these venues are excellent sources of a wide range of information all available in the one location
 - Support businesses and service providers – such as:
 - Carriers – operating to and from the destination
 - Accommodation providers – within the country/community
- The internet – which is an excellent multi-purpose tool (see next section):
- Formal training courses – which can be useful for a range of reasons (see next section)
- Institutions – such as:
 - Museums
 - Galleries
 - Cultural centres.



1.2 Research and interpret sources of information

Introduction

With a sound understanding of the information sources available the next step is to use these sources to research and interpret information.

This section provides a range of background considerations and terminology regarding research; it discusses the use of identified sources and lists a range of potential research topics.

Background considerations

Researching

In this context 'researching' can be seen as:

- Systematic and structured investigation
- Watching, reading, listening and experiencing
- Finding and capturing information
- Fact-finding
- Exploration and visitations.

Qualitative and quantitative research

Qualitative research is about capturing information relating to:

- Thoughts, feelings and impressions
- Reasons and causes
- Opinion, motivation and preferences
- Why people behave/take action the way they do
- Things which are not statistical in nature.

Quantitative research is about capturing and manipulating:

- Numbers and statistics
- Percentages and ratios
- Measurable facts and data.



Secondary research

Secondary research is research conducted using materials which already exist.

It is essentially desk-top research involving:

- Reading existing material and reprints
- Looking at research undertaken by other people
- Becoming aware of what is available without the need for further effort.

Primary research

Primary research involves taking action to generate fresh/new research findings and information that has never been collected previously.

It can involve:

- Talking to people to obtain their input
- Asking questions
- Conducting tests and trials
- Implementing various market research techniques.

Interpreting

For the purposes of this unit ‘interpreting’ refers to activities applied to the material, data and information generated from the research process – such as:

- Making sense of what has been obtained/discovered
- Identifying meaning from the information
- Working out how information can/might/will be used
- Analysing data
- Evaluating information
- Performing calculations
- Assessing the usefulness of material gathered
- Sequencing facts and putting them in the correct order.



Tips and advice

The following have emerged as useful points to observe when researching:

- It is always best to use a *combination* of sources to generate research data when researching any aspect of indigenous culture – as opposed to relying on just one source.
- Always note/record the sources used to capture information – in order the source may be:
 - Cited/quoted if required
 - Re-visited as and when necessary to check facts and figures, and/or obtain further information
- Use a mix of research approaches/data types – in terms of:
 - Qualitative and quantitative research
 - Primary and secondary research options
- Make notes, obtain copies or capture images when researching – so they can form the basis of the materials which will be generated.

Never rely solely on memory.

- Check the currency of the materials used as the basis for research – it is not essential for all materials to be ‘the latest’ but it is imperative researchers understand the time/year those materials were generated in order to:
 - Give context to the information
 - Indicate whether more current materials might exist
 - Determine whether the information sourced can/should be used
- The research process can be a complex activity and it needs to be properly resourced – this means there is a need to:
 - Allocate sufficient time to the research – research needs to begin well in advance of the need to use/share the material generated by the process
 - Allocate sufficient funds – for meetings, travel, purchase of source materials. preparation of materials to be shared with tour group members
 - Allocate sufficient staff to undertake all the research and associated activities – such as meetings, reading, and preparation of draft materials for sharing, reviewing and revising draft materials.

Using the identified sources

Printed material

Practical research requires:

- Generating a personal library of reference material – which:
 - Grows over time
 - Is available to all those who need it
 - Should be managed/classified to facilitate access to information which may be needed from time-to-time
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of travel guides for the identified indigenous cultures. Popular travel guides are those by Fodor’s, Lonely Planet and Frommer’s but others also exist
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of literature/texts – on generic topics such as:
 - History
 - Science
 - Anthropology
 - Geography
- Obtaining, reading and taking notes from a range of magazines – which may include:
 - Articles from general-purpose/circulation publications
 - Travel and tourism-specific magazines
- Gathering and analysing the material contained in advertising brochures and promotional materials – generated by other operators and commercial enterprises.



The general media

Research involving the general media can involve:

- Watching television programmes and documentaries relating to:
 - Travel and tourism
 - Target countries and cultures
 - Certain aspects of interest relating to identified communities
- Listening to radio interviews – which feature:
 - Indigenous peoples
 - Community leaders
 - Tour Operators and Tour Guides
 - Tourists who have been to target destinations
- Reading culture- and indigenous community-related articles contained in the Travel and Tourism section (or features) of newspapers – these may be:
 - Regular columns by reporters and travellers who have visited target destinations
 - Special (or ‘feature’) reports which occur from time-to-time on a range of different countries
 - Articles by industry bodies and/or government authorities on certain aspects of countries, communities or cultures.

People from identified communities

Research activities involving people from identified communities may involve:

- Meeting with them
- Taking to them
- Visiting their communities
- Experiencing their culture
- Participating in local activities
- Recording personal experiences for later analysis/interpretation
- Taking a tour to a target destination as a tourist on a tour conducted by another Tour Operator.



Industry personnel

Research activities involving industry personnel can entail:

- Talking with Tour Guides – particularly those who have experience and specialised knowledge of different peoples and cultures
- Meeting with representatives from peak industry bodies – with the aim of capturing information they already have and referral information (to contact persons/points) they may be able to provide

- Speaking with officers from government agencies and authorities – who have responsibility for Tourism, Culture, Trade or other related/associated matters and are often able to provide:
 - Valuable statistical information
 - Details of any plans and proposals relating to the target destination
 - Details of schemes/incentives to encourage and support tourism activities in/to target destinations
- Visiting Visitor Information centres of target countries/communities (where these exist) – in order to:
 - Talk to Information Officers
 - Obtain hard copy, take-away promotional materials produced by local Tour Operators
 - Obtain documentation available from other Tour Operators relating to operational matters – such as sample itineraries, fees and charges, tour schedules, terms and conditions
- Visiting and or talking to support businesses and service providers – to:
 - Gain an idea of the products and services available to support/enable tours and interpretive activities to be undertaken into the destinations
 - Gauge cost/prices of materials being sold
 - Determine attitude of third party providers towards tourism initiatives into their area
 - Learn about and from their previous experience with Tour Operators and what they have done right and/or wrong in relation to the country/community.

The internet

Using the internet as part of the desk-top research component of the process can involve:

- Undertaking targeted searches – on destinations, required aspects (as identified as being the focus for planned tours, activities and inclusions)
- Accessing publicly listed/released reports and documentation – as prepared by (for example) government agencies and industry bodies
- Following-up and gaining additional material on knowledge already obtained from other sources
- Obtaining names of people, places and businesses for subsequent personal/face-to-face contact
- Making contact with potential joint-venture partners
- Subscribing to relevant online newsletters and email alerts
- Monitoring relevant travel and tourism blogs and discussion forums/chat rooms.



Formal training courses

Formal training courses can be useful to:

- Study a country, culture of community
- Learn about the history of a region or community
- Learn how to undertake formal research processes
- Meet others with similar interests



Institutions

Using institutions as part of the research process generally requires:

- Visiting the locations
- Talking with curators
- Viewing the exhibitions
- Engaging with the displays
- Obtaining 'Fact Sheets' and other materials distributed to visitors
- Understanding how/if these institutions can become part of a trip, tour or activity.

Possible research topics

The research being conducted will *always* focus on the ideas a Tour Operator has regarding proposed tours and activities.

In many cases, this will be the sole focus of the research and interpretation processes.

This said, information on indigenous cultures which may be the focus of research may be related to:

- History of the people – which can be divided into different sections as appropriate to the country and the plans of the Tour Operator.
 - Two commonly used divisions are:
 - Time before contact with western or other cultures and societies
 - Time after the above contact
- The traditional life of the people – including reference to:
 - Customs, tools and practices
 - The family unit
 - Community life
 - The unique nature of the culture/community
 - Contrast with their contemporary life
- Art, dance and music – which can address:
 - The different types of art practices by the people including materials and instruments used
 - Examples of work produced
 - Reasons why art, dance and music was produced
 - Role of same in community life

- Oral history of the people – in terms of process and content with reference to:
 - Story telling
 - Legends
 - Myths
- Tools and implements – used for:
 - Day-to-day living
 - Farming and agriculture
 - Warfare
- Foods of the people – including coverage of:
 - Items and ingredients
 - Cooking processes and practices/dishes prepared
 - Beverages
- Artefacts of the local community – these can be:
 - Items made by the people that have cultural significance
 - Things produced locally which are of local uniqueness
 - Items of historical significance
- Symbols and symbolic actions of the people – with reference to:
 - Why the symbols exist and why the symbolic actions are taken
 - What they are
 - When and where they are used
- Rituals, rites, ceremonies and celebrations – to determine:
 - Reasons they exist and are observed
 - Names and dates – or times they are observed
 - Activities inherent in each
- Heroes and significant figures and individuals – to identify:
 - Who they are
 - Why they are significant and what they did
 - Their role in the community
- Beliefs, assumptions, values and attitudes – with reference to:
 - What these are
 - Why they are held
 - Their impact on the life of the people
- Language – to ascertain:
 - The evolution of the language
 - Basic terms, words and phrases
 - Verbal and non-verbal components



- Religion – to identify:
 - Beliefs and religious organisation
 - Religious practices
- Education – and details such as:
 - What content is deemed relevant
 - How knowledge is communicated/transferred
 - Significant institutions and achievements
- Social institutions which exist within communities (such as governments, health and welfare systems, educational systems, business structures, judicial systems) – to determine:
 - What they are
 - What they are called
 - How they function
- Cultural sites – to identify:
 - What they are and where they are located
 - Their names
 - What they are used for and why they are important
- Geography – in terms of:
 - Layout of the country
 - Natural features
 - Statistical information
 - Environmental issues
- Entertainment – regarding (for example):
 - Domestic leisure activities
 - Games played by children and adults
 - Sports.



Websites

It will be useful to visit the following websites for extra information on this section of the unit:

- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Primary_research - Primary research
- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Secondary_research - Secondary research
- <https://explorable.com/quantitative-and-qualitative-research> - Quantitative and qualitative research
- <http://www.lonelyplanet.com/> - Lonely Planet
- <http://www.frommers.com/> - Frommer's
- <http://www.fodors.com/guidebooks/> - Fodor's guidebooks
- http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/List_of_travel_magazines - List of travel magazines
- <http://www.studylecturenotes.com/basics-of-sociology/what-are-the-basic-elements-of-religion> - What are the basic elements of religion?
- http://www.academia.edu/5237947/ASEAN_Tourism_Policy_and_Planning - Regional tourism policy and planning ASEAN
- <http://www.asean.org/communities/asean-economic-community/item/plan-of-action-on-asean-cooperation-in-tourism> - Plan of action on ASEAN cooperation in tourism
- <http://www.scribd.com/doc/111871570/ASEAN-Tourism-Strategic-Plan-2011-2015#scribd> – ASEAN Tourism strategic plan 2011 – 2015.



1.3 Demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture(s)

Introduction

There is a non-negotiable need for all research – and all activities flowing from the research – demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their cultures.

This section discusses the need to demonstrate this respect for indigenous peoples and their cultures and presents a range of basic actions which will demonstrate the required respect.

Need to demonstrate/observe respect for indigenous cultures

Reasons for demonstrating respect for indigenous cultures are generally related to one or more factors.

Note these factors are not 'constant' and may:

- Alter over time
- Vary between different tour group
- Change between specialised custom/private tours
- Differ between different communities and cultures.

The factors underpinning the need for respect for indigenous cultures are generally related to:

- The need to preserve unique cultures – so that what they have and what they represent is not lost to mankind through being absorbed into other cultures and/or over-taken by other priorities. This aim is often set against a need to save an entire culture/way of life from fading into the mists of time by avoiding what often seems to be the very slow but nonetheless relentless disappearance of a whole culture/society
- A desire to *share* knowledge – so more/other people learn about a rare/unique culture/community, what they are, how they function and how they live. This desire is often related to the preservation of a culture but it differs in that the primary aim is to make more people aware of what actually exists. Some argue that by doing this it actually raises the potential for the indigenous culture to be exploited or destroyed if 'too many' people become aware of it and what it may have to offer
- A need change the attitudes of visitors – this can be borne out of a desire to:
 - Present a culture in a different way
 - Offer a rarely seen aspect of the culture/community to outside eyes
 - Explain why a people do what they do based on the facts and actual context/reality of their lives



- Realisation by society in general, a country/Government of a range of issues including:
 - Valuing individuals and different cultures and communities for who they are and the individual way they live their lives
 - Recognising the contribution people/communities have made to other cultures and/or the wider world
 - Acknowledging the right of different people to live in different ways
- Acceptance on the part of society in relation changing attitudes – such that what was ignored or treated with suspicion or indifference years ago is now a valid and legitimate way of life or orientation. This often relates to the concept today's world/society can learn something from a previous world or society
- A need on the part of the Tour Operator (and associated Government agencies/tourism bodies) to ensure no offence is given by tour group when they visit indigenous communities/cultures – in relation to things such as:
 - How visitors speak and dress in their presence
 - The way in which tour group interact with them
 - Actions taken by individuals when in indigenous communities
- A desire of the part of tours/Tour Operators to protect the 'normal' way of life of indigenous cultures – from:
 - Unintended consequences of interacting with other peoples/cultures
 - The encroachment of other civilisations
 - Unwanted intrusions across a range of fronts such as political, economic, moral, religious
- A vested interest on the part of a Tour Operator in creating a more positive relationship/rapprochement with the communities which will be more conducive to:
 - Future deals/negotiations involving tours and visitations to their communities
 - More lucrative financial arrangements between the parties
 - Better working relationships between everyone.
- An obligation to comply with legislation – which is imposed by law to protect the various rights of certain cultures, communities and people such as their:
 - Human rights
 - Civil rights
 - Constitutional rights
 - Civil liberties.



Demonstrating respect

Underlying requirements

In order to actually demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture/s it is vital to begin with:

- A genuine desire to engage with the communities
- A willingness to learn from the people
- Preparedness to:
 - Walk away from a community if they are not interested/do not want to be involved with the Tour Operator
 - Accept decisions made by the people in the community
- A working framework (Tour Operator policies and procedures) which underpin respectful treatment of/engagement with indigenous people and their culture/s.



Practical actions

Practical actions to demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture/s when researching information may include:

- Doing desk-top or other research (speaking to recognised experts; undertaking web-based research; reading relevant texts) about the community before making initial direct contact with the community – to:
 - Gain a basic understanding of the community/people
 - Learn about particular community cultural preferences and/or taboos
- ‘Asking’ permission to meet – as opposed to:
 - Demanding a meeting or information
 - Starting the local research process without prior contact, introductions, explanations and (where necessary) offers of payment
- Only communicating with designated persons – as identified as a result of:
 - The desk-top research
 - Advice received directly from the community
- Seeking approval/permission to undertake certain activities which historically have raised issues with indigenous communities – such as:
 - Taking photographs/video or any form of recording
 - Entering buildings/houses and ‘sacred’ sites
 - Speaking to women or children
 - Touching/handling or removing items

- Displaying visible behaviours and practices consistent with cultural sensitivity and awareness – which will vary between individual cultures but may require/relate to:
 - Dressing appropriately
 - Avoiding eye contact
 - Controlling volume when speaking
 - Avoiding use of certain words, terms or phrases
 - Avoiding body language and gestures which are locally offensive or otherwise unacceptable
- Giving prior notification of intentions and requests – as opposed to making such requests 'on-the-spot'.

These might relate to specific research activities such as:

- Talking to nominated individuals or groups
- Obtaining nominated information
- Observing activities within the community
- Making recordings for use in promotional and other materials
- Accommodating local preferences for critical communication factors – such as:
 - Location for meetings and information sessions/exchanges
 - Timing of these meetings
 - Method/s of communication to be used
- Speaking with the community to establish meeting and/or communication protocols – to enable meetings/sessions to occur efficiently, effectively and respectfully, such as:
 - Determining local contacts/representatives as elected, nominated or approved by the community
 - Identifying meetings procedures – in terms of a range of possible factors such as:
 - Level of formality
 - Seating arrangements
 - Those who can/cannot attend meetings
- Being prepared to pay for the time and contribution of individuals and/or the local community – for input regarding (for example):
 - Attending meetings
 - Providing information
 - Undertaking research on behalf of the Tour Operator
 - Reviewing, editing and approving draft materials prepared by the Tour Operator



- Stating clearly and being prepared to commit to writing the intention of the Tour Operator to abide by identified protocols – such as:
 - Never revealing information deemed by the indigenous community to be secret
 - Observing procedures as contained in a nominated Code of Conduct/Practice for working with indigenous communities
 - Always presenting materials/information to be used by the Tour Operator to the community for their approval before it is used
 - Seeking consent for the Tour Operator to hold certain cultural information – as distinct from assuming the Tour Operator has a *right* to do this
- Seeking local community permission to share their cultural information – and obtaining agreements regarding:
 - How this may and may not occur
 - The duration of the permission granted
 - Payment for same
 - Protocols for obtaining approval to use material that is required.



1.4 Determine how information on indigenous cultures should be used

Introduction

A vital aspect relating to all information obtained on indigenous cultures is the need to determine how that information can or should be used.

This short but important section highlights the need to document discussions on these talks and presents options for action to help determine the acceptable use of information gained from indigenous communities/cultures.

Documenting talks

It should be standard practice to document meetings and talks with local communities and indigenous people – in order to:

- Provide a basis for future reference – so materials produced reflect the wishes expressed by the people during the talks, visits and meetings
- Show evidence of the consultation process – in order to help maintain the reputation of the Tour Operator as being sensitive to local communities and indigenous people
- Create a growing body of knowledge – about the communities and cultures
- Generate a document which can be shared with stakeholders – to:
 - Provide a record of what was discussed
 - List stated agreements and arrangements made at meetings
 - Provide a basis for future discussion/follow-up
- Show respect for the consultation process – in that recording the meetings demonstrates proof of the value of the talks and shows a serious orientation to matters discussed



Determining acceptable use

Over time the following practices have evolved as effective and respectful methods for determining the acceptable use of information sourced from indigenous cultures and communities.

As with research actions, it is best to use a combination of the identified practices below rather than just a single approach.

The standard practices include:

- Differentiating between, and agreeing about, material which is already in the public domain – and already/readily available to others.

This can be done by:

- Verbally discussing the material

- Showing copies/evidence of existing material. Material already available to the public comes with far fewer restrictions attached to its use providing there is agreement and acceptance about the content and its veracity
- Establishing a schedule for communication in this regard – which needs to accommodate the needs, wants and preferences of the local people as these relate to:
 - Dates and times
 - Meeting places
 - Those who can or must be present
 - Meeting protocols – seating arrangement, presence of recording devices, refreshments
 - Whether people require payment for attendance
- Informing the community of the specifics of Tour Operator intention to use material and information provided **before research and meetings commence** – so the people are:
 - Genuinely aware of the reasons for the talks
 - Fully understand why the information is being sought

This can help them decide:

 - What they want to disclose
 - What they want to keep secret
 - If they require payment for their input/contributions
- Verifying with the indigenous community that researched information has been correctly interpreted – and:
 - Allowing the community the right to review materials produced – so they remain engaged with the process of participating in the development and release of material and so they can:
 - Approve and/or amend the proposed items
 - Reject the way certain information is presented
 - Giving the community the right to veto material – so they know they:
 - Are respected as an integral part of the process
 - Retain final control over the information released/provided
- Understanding with all communities there will **nearly always** be a range of sensitive and/or contentious issues – such as:
 - Things the community does not agree about
 - Matters the people have difficulty explaining
 - Culturally-sensitive matters (times, events, practices or customs) which the community:
 - Does not want to talk about at all
 - Wants handled/treated in a certain way
 - Access to certain people, places and/or practices



- Never making assumptions relating to the community and the information it provides – for example it is never acceptable/respectful to:
 - Assume the community knows about the Tour Operator and what it does
 - Assume the people know what Tour Operators do and the tourism industry is
 - Assume all materials and information provided can be used for tour-related/tourism purposes
- Checking with the indigenous community about material which has been researched through desk-top procedures and via primary research techniques – to determine:
 - Truth and accuracy of the content
 - Whether or not the information is able to be used and shared with tour groups
 - Preferences/limitations which might apply to the dissemination or sharing of certain pieces of information – for example, there may be:
 - Bans on sharing with women
 - Restrictions on access to areas/sites
 - Times/seasons when material cannot be shared
 - Bans on using names of certain people or places
 - Refusal to provide items for use as samples/models for showing to tour groups
 - Prohibition on certain interpretive activities which have been proposed
- Deciding on follow-up protocols – as these might apply to:
 - Monitoring activities to record and track the impact of activities designed and implemented as a result of the information provided/agreed to
 - Reporting procedures for communicating and discussing the data produced as a result of agreed monitoring protocols
 - Review and revision practices – for considering materials which have been produced and are subject to evaluation
- Developing an ongoing rapport/connection with the local people – to:
 - Continue meeting with indigenous communities
 - Establish a 'reference group' to deal with the Tour Operator
 - Encourage their participation in the development of appropriate activities and commentaries to share their culture
 - Identify commercial opportunities available to them – if required/applicable.



Website

Take time to visit and read:



<http://www.onecaribbean.org/content/files/GoodPracticesTourismawareness%282%29.pdf> – Competing with the best: Good practices in tourism awareness programs.

<http://green.hotelscombined.com/Rtg-Benefits-of-Tourism.php> - Benefits of tourism.

http://sanctuaries.noaa.gov/management/pdfs/Day5_H2_BenefitsThreats.pdf - Some benefits for local communities; some threats for local communities.

<http://social.eyeforpharma.com/column/untapped-potential-asean-key-growth-factors> - The untapped potential of ASEAN: the key growth factors.

<http://www.reportlinker.com/d0104205547/Tourism-Industry-in-Asia.html?pos=5> – Tourism industry in Asia.

Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project forms the basis of all following Work Projects for this Unit.

1.1 Identify an Indigenous community as a focus for this activity and research information on this community providing evidence you have:

- Identified relevant sources of information for this indigenous culture
- Researched at least three of identified sources of information for this indigenous culture
- Interpreted material obtained from the identified sources of information for use as part of tour to and/or interpretive activities within those communities
- Demonstrated respect for indigenous people and their culture with reference to how information from them was obtained
- Determined how information on the indigenous culture could be used so as to respect cultural sensitivities and observe required confidentiality.

Summary

Research information on indigenous cultures

When researching information on indigenous cultures:

- Understand the organisational definitions of relevant terms
- Identify the specific countries, cultures and communities which need to be researched
- Work to understand the overall context of tourism relating to indigenous people
- Speak to management and other Tour Guides to identify suitable sources of information on indigenous people
- Seek to identify and use multiple information sources on indigenous people
- Be proactive in undertaking research
- Seek to generate qualitative and quantitative data as a result of the research
- Begin the research with secondary research/desk-top research
- Allocate sufficient time and resources to research
- Take notes and record sources of information
- Engage indigenous people and visit their countries and communities
- Speak with industry bodies and authorities
- Gather information on topics which are likely to be the focus of tours and interpretive activities for the Tour Operator
- Always demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture/s
- Document all talks and meetings with indigenous people
- Determine acceptable use of the information provided by indigenous people
- Never assume all information learned can be freely shared with others.

Element 2: Share information on indigenous cultures

2.1 Communicate general knowledge to colleagues

Introduction

When the information obtained as a result of research and communication with indigenous people, there is a need to share this information with colleagues.

This section identifies the need to do this and presents basic strategies to share the information that has been obtained.

Need to communicate information with colleagues

There is a need to conduct a session to share with colleagues the information learned/gained for the following reasons:

- To demonstrate evidence regarding the time and effort spent undertaking the research – so that:
 - Others can see what was achieved
 - Proof is visible to show resources was well spent
 - Give others a better appreciate of the scope of the research – as they often have little idea about what is involved in comprehensive research of this nature
- To provide general background knowledge about the intentions of the Tour Operator – these information sessions traditionally also feature:
 - Future general/strategic plans of the company
 - Changes proposed for new/different target markets and/or re-positioning of the business in the marketplace
 - Specific plans as they relate to the development of the market in relation to the individual indigenous culture/people being discussed – n terms of (for example) coverage and details regarding anticipated:
 - Types of tours and interpretive activities being proposed – including overview of inclusions, duration, cost/selling price
 - Itineraries
 - Tour schedules
 - Predicted traffic and sales volume



- To explain relevant other matters – as they may relate to:
 - Action already being taken by other Tour Operators
 - Proposed actions of competitors
 - Plans and schemes proposed or available through industry bodies and/or government agencies to support/promote tourism in the target destination/s
- To make sure relevant others have full knowledge of all material gained – so these people can use the knowledge to:
 - Conduct further research
 - Develop tours and activities
 - Create and produce promotional material
 - Begin selling activities
 - Generate handouts and scripts for commentaries
- To foster a culture of sharing and consultation:
 - Between staff
 - Within the organisation
 - Among joint-venture partners.



Strategies for sharing information

Strategies for sharing information commonly take two forms:

- Internal (on-the-job) communication
- External ('in country') communication.

Some strategies listed below can be used in both/either form – for example, meeting with and talking to community members/representatives could take place 'in the office' or in their community.

Internal communication

Internal sharing of information generally:

- Precedes external communication
- Involves everyone involved with promotion, sales, guiding and operational matters.

Tour operators use the following procedures for internal sharing information on indigenous communities and cultures with colleagues.

- Scheduling communication sessions – which entails:
 - Determining suitable dates and times for the sessions
 - Arranging support resources for the presentation – such as catering and technologies required to use (for example) PowerPoint presentations, video playback and to play sound recordings
 - Sending invitations to those who should attend
 - Arranging for back-filling of staff who need to attend information sessions
 - Monitoring attendance at the sessions
 - Conducting extra sessions as/if required and following-up with those who were unable to attend

- Planning the session – in terms of
 - What to say/present – this is the content of the presentation/details of the information which will be provided. There is usually inclusion of rationale/reason the Tour Operator wants to engage with this market/community. See 'Conducting the presentation' (below) for sample topics to include
 - Sequence of presentation – this is the order in which material will be delivered and is often prepared in the form of a written 'session plan' to guide the presentation
 - Duration and timing issues – regarding:
 - Starting and finishing time
 - Time for each portion of the session
 - Allowance for a Q&A session – always include such a session and always make it the final aspect of the session: try to avoid taking questions during the presentation as this can disrupt flow and adversely impact timing
 - Form of presentation – with common options being:
 - Verbal presentations
 - Handouts
 - Slides, overheads and PowerPoint shows
 - Video and audio recordings
 - Guest speakers
- Developing the range of materials to be used during the session – which must always address:
 - The needs of the presenter – to use during/as part of the presentation
 - Materials to be distributed to those who attend



In practice these materials may need to include:

- Slides
- Overhead projection sheets/ transparencies
- PowerPoint slides
- Handouts – such as:
 - Statistics
 - Photographs
 - Fact/Information sheets
 - Contact names and numbers
 - Copies of reports
 - Examples of promotional material/s from other Tour Operators relating to the community being targeted
- Video and audio recordings

- Conducting the session – which will traditionally include:
 - Welcoming the colleagues and thanking them for attending
 - Explaining reason for the session
 - Following the plan for the session – which may involve:
 - Passing on general, background information on the culture/community
 - Communicating specific information gathered on the topics of interest to the Tour Operator
 - Explaining aspects of the culture/community/country relevant to Tour Operator plans, proposals and intentions
 - Providing demonstrations to assist understanding
 - Describing proposed interpretive activities
 - Listing sites and destinations for visitation
 - Noting tours and activities already being conducted into the destination by other Tour Operators
 - Identifying incentives available (from other operators, government agencies) to support engagement with the community
 - Explaining what (if anything) the community requires in exchange for their cooperation
 - Advising colleagues about what can and what cannot be shared with others – and indicating other restrictions which have already been identified at this stage of discussions/negotiations.



External communication

External sharing of information generally:

- Follows initial external communication
- Involves fewer people than the internal notification – this means this aspect of communication may be limited to:
 - Tour Guides who will be leading tours into the destination
 - Staff who will be involved in conducting on-site interpretive activities
 - Key sales and advertising staff.

Standard generic procedures include:

- Determining persons who are to attend – commonly selecting from:
 - Staff within the Tour Operator business (as identified immediately above)
 - Personnel from joint-venture partners
 - Media outlets
 - Government (tourism-related) agencies

- Requesting permission from the community to visit them and introduce nominated staff – this is an *essential* element which must be undertaken in order to:
 - Demonstrate respect
 - Form the basis for all future contact/s with the community
 - Further develop the relationship which has already been started
 - Prove the community is acknowledged, recognised and valued – and not taken for granted
 - Advise community of what the visit seeks to achieve and what personnel want to do, see and who they wish to talk to
- Arranging necessary travel arrangements – which might necessitate:
 - Organising tickets and/or transport
 - Determining accommodation
 - Identifying dates and times
 - Confirming arrangements with target destination/community
- Visiting the community – which will require:
 - Observing local/previously identified protocols
 - introducing colleagues to local communities and designated people (elders, community leaders)
 - Engaging in talks and meetings with local people
 - Touring the area/community
 - Viewing sites and activities
 - Describing proposed tours and activities within their actual context/location
 - Capturing additional information, photographs and ‘missing’ data
 - Identifying new tour-related opportunities
 - Conducting model tours and interpretive activities
 - Discussing potential impact of Tour Operator tours/activities on the community identifying options for mitigating same
 - Repeating/confirming Tour Operator intention of working collaboratively with the community
 - Thanking the community.



2.2 Use indigenous guides and/or interpreters where possible

Introduction

Conducting tours into indigenous communities should always raise the need to consider using local people to assist with conducting tours and presenting interpretive activities.

This section examines the broader issues associated with the introduction of tourism-related activity into an indigenous community, defines and discusses 'engagement' of indigenous people, identifies the roles which can be undertaken by local people, and presents reasons for engaging indigenous people to help with tours.

Issues associated with introducing tourism to indigenous cultures

On the basis of experience the following are issues which are frequently raised when communities are asked to engage with proposed tourism activities in their areas.

Issues can be separated into positive and negative.

Positive issues

Positive issues have been identified as:

- Growth of existing businesses
- Development of new businesses
- More jobs and employment opportunities
- A more sustainable economy
- Improved quality of life for people/families flowing from employment, economic growth and stability
- Greater investment in local infrastructure and public transport systems from governments
- Maintenance, growth and improvement in local facilities
- Cultural empowerment and increased sense of pride as locals become ambassadors for tourism in their region
- Tax revenue for governments
- Enhanced public/international awareness of the country/location
- Economic diversification and general economic benefits to the local community
- Opportunity to share the culture and educate visitors
- Investment opportunities from the private sector in relation to businesses, real estate, and infrastructure
- Improved health and training facilities
- Opportunity to enhance the preservation of endangered or threatened aspects of the local culture, customs and community
- Opportunity to make the wider community aware of the problems facing the community.



Negative issues

Negative issues may include:

- Impact of tourism on the social fabric of society
- Child protection and child sex trade concerns
- A fear regarding prostitution and other crimes
- Trivialisation and/or dilution of the culture
- Lack of local workers to fill the jobs which are generated
- Provision only of menial and low-paid jobs
- Seasonal employment only (in some areas)
- Loss of a sense of community within the area
- Ultimate dependency on tourism and consequent need to accommodate whatever is required regardless of the consequences
- Damage to the land and environment including additional pollution
- Money leaving the area because businesses are owned by external operators
- Unacceptable level of use of/stress on community resources by tourists to the detriment of the local community – over-crowding and (traffic) congestion
- Over-development resulting in decreased amenity of the area
- Increased living costs
- Unwanted intervention by tourists in normal everyday activities
- Control of the local area may move (more) to external people, businesses or authorities
- Cultural change – as tourism negatively impacts/influences the lives of the locals.

Websites

Visit the sites below for supplementary information:



http://www3.weforum.org/docs/WEF_TTCR_ASEAN_ExecutiveSummary_2012.pdf - The ASEAN Travel and Tourism Competitiveness Report 2012.

http://www.tourismkm-asean.org/wp-content/pdf/impact_of_fta/unwto_report_on_asean_tourism_integration.pdf - ASEAN integration and its impact on tourism.

http://www.academia.edu/5237947/ASEAN_Tourism_Policy_and_Planning - ASEAN tourism planning and policy.

<http://green.hotelscombined.com/Rtg-Benefits-of-Tourism.php> - Benefits of tourism.

http://sanctuaries.noaa.gov/management/pdfs/Day5_H2_BenefitsThreats.pdf - Some benefits for local communities; some threats for local communities.

<http://www.tourisme.gouv.qc.ca/activites/symposium-developpement-durable/presentations/17-C-15h20-2-Richard-Butler.pdf> - Benefits to communities of sustainable tourism.

Engagement of indigenous people

‘Engagement’ of indigenous people for tour-related activities means ‘paying them to deliver part of the prepared tour program’.

The details of payment needs to:

- Be negotiated with them – as opposed to being imposed on
- Comply with applicable laws and Codes of Practice – regarding employment and involvement of indigenous people/workers.

Roles which can be undertaken by local people

Local indigenous people may be engaged in a wide variety of roles – these include:

- Assisting in the development of suitable, interesting and acceptable tours and interpretive activities – as part of the development process, in terms of:
 - Identifying whether or not proposals by the Tour Operator are acceptable or not to the local community
 - Suggesting more or alternate ideas for tours and activities
 - Describing seasonal influences on weather, access, availability of areas, resources, flora and fauna
 - Providing required information and resources
 - Contributing vital insight and detail to enhance materials such as promotional materials, scripted commentaries, handouts for tour group members, plans for tours and interpretive activities
 - Helping obtain local permission/s to conduct tours, have access to required areas, meet with locals, present activities and provide support services
- Welcoming tourists and tour groups – which may involve:
 - Traditional greeting or welcome ceremony
 - Making presentations of local items and/or food on arrival
- Providing generic Tour Guide services – where they:
 - Take over the tour after tour groups have arrived and been welcomed
 - Conduct only designated sections/aspects of tours
 - Supply local knowledge and input to supplement the scripted commentary given by the usual Tour Guide
 - Introduce the group to local people
 - Facilitate access to areas and resources
 - Accompany small groups throughout the tour (which is led by the usual Tour Guide)



- Presenting interpretive activities – such as:
 - Story-telling
 - Doing demonstrations
 - Performing song and dance
 - Conducting explorations and exercises
 - Leading de-briefing sessions after activities have been completed
- Providing entertainment – in terms of:
 - Singing, music and dancing
 - Presentations of local art and culture
 - Explanation and description of local customs, rites and ceremonies
- Providing specialist Tour Guiding services – as appropriate to distinct/individual tours such as those which have a focus on one or more of the following:
 - Observing wildlife
 - Cooking
 - Observing religious and other celebrations and rites
 - Participating in local activities – such as sports, games, tests and trials, dance, hunting
 - Learning language
 - Participating in family life
 - Trekking and safaris
 - Overnight camping
- Providing local travel/transport services – such as:
 - Driving of local tour vehicles in indigenous lands
 - Operating water craft on rivers and other waters
 - Flying helicopters or 'planes
- Delivering ancillary services – which may include:
 - Providing safety and security services
 - Interpreting and translating
 - Providing liaison between the tour party/group and the local community
 - Loading and unloading services
 - Carrying supplies and equipment
 - Distributing materials
 - Cleaning
 - Catering.



Reasons for engaging indigenous guides and interpreters

The primary reasons for engaging indigenous people with tour-related activities are:

- Many tour groups expect this to occur – they expect to meet and interact with local indigenous people so their involvement helps meet expectations and raise the levels of customer satisfaction with the tour experience
- The involvement of local people allows their participation to be advertised in promotions for the tour – thereby raising interest and making the tour more attractive to potential purchasers of tickets
- Their presence on-tour and in activities provides a unique experience for tour group members – in terms of a range of factors such as:
 - Visual impact on tourists – they provide immediate local ‘colour and movement’
 - The sound of their voices
 - Their smell
 - Ability to interact at a personal one-on-one level with an indigenous person – as opposed to observing them ‘at a distance’
 - Their willingness to be photographed/video’s by tour groups
- The use of local guides and interpreters has traditionally been shown to be more effective – in terms of:
 - Reducing adverse impact of tours on the local community
 - Lessening the potential for damage to the local environment
 - Lowering threat levels which may be posed by local communities and/or conditions
- Their participation in tours may create a point of difference for the purposes of sales and marketing – where competition does not feature engagement with locals
- Local people are obviously best able to perform a number of common and necessary tour-related tasks – such as:
 - Explain local conditions and customs
 - Lead the way to areas where required sighting can be made and nominated experiences can be had
 - Describe the local landscape, flora, fauna, weather, environmental conditions and similar aspects relevant to the tour and in response to questions asked by the tour group
 - Monitor the actions of tour groups in relation to behaviour likely to give local offence or cause other problems
 - Discuss the indigenous family and social structures
 - Speak the language
 - Demonstrate local skills
 - Mediate disputes/problems between locals and tour groups



- Genuine engagement with the local community by the Tour Operator demonstrates a positive Tour Operator orientation to the people – by:
 - Showing respect for their knowledge
 - Acknowledging the potential they have to contribute
 - Positioning themselves to receive immediate feedback from the community regarding the impact of tours and activities on the community – so changes can be made to arrangements where/if required
 - Assisting the growth of the local community by making a financial contribution to the area/people
- It may be a mandated requirement – as prescribed by:
 - In-country legislation
 - An applicable Code of Conduct to which the Tour Operator subscribes or by which they are bound
 - Internal agreements which have been developed by the community to govern contact and interaction with Tour Operators
 - The terms and conditions attaching to funding/incentives offered by governments to encourage and assist development of tourist activity in nominated countries/communities.



2.3 Brief tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with indigenous people

Introduction

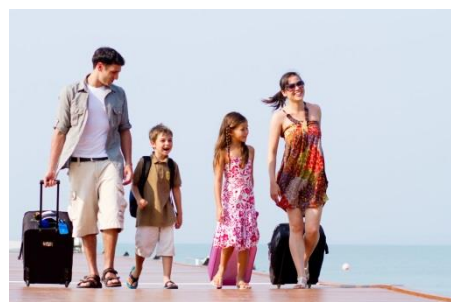
When conducting a tour to an indigenous culture there is always a need to brief tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with the local people.

This section discusses the need for a Behaviour Briefing, identified how and where the briefing might occur and presents topics which are often addressed as part of the briefing.

Need for the briefing

A briefing ('Behaviour Briefing') to notify tour group members of appropriate/inappropriate and acceptable/unacceptable behaviour when on-tour in an indigenous community is important for the following reasons – to:

- Maintain the dignity of the local community – through:
 - Taking actions which respect their values and beliefs
 - Refraining from actions which cause offence
- Protect indigenous people from unwanted intrusion – in terms of:
 - Being observed by others
 - Being engaged in discussions and interactions with tourists
- Prevent interference with normal indigenous activities – such as:
 - Family activities
 - Traditional day-to-day life
 - Religious celebrations and rites
- Present the boundaries of acceptable behaviour and language – and unacceptable behaviour and language (see 'Content of the briefing' below)
- Set tour group members 'at ease' – by advising them in advance of what they can and cannot do and say. Many tour group members appreciate the setting of such 'boundaries' as they are often nervous about causing unintended offence to others
- Describe consequences for the tour group if the requirements are not complied with – see below
- Honour tour-related agreements made with local people – in terms of:
 - Actually *presenting* the briefing to every group for every tour, excursion or activity
 - Content of the briefing identified by the local community as being essential to their individual need
- Abide by Codes of Practice by which the Tour Operator is bound – or to which they subscribe which requires such a briefing to precede all such tours and activities.



Location, form and timing of the briefing

The briefing may be delivered in several ways.

It is commonly:

- A verbal presentation made by the Tour Guide
- Supplemented by demonstrations, hard copy handouts/information sheets and/or a short video/DVD.

The briefing is commonly presented:

- In a room or other designated location at the offices of the Tour Operator before the tour/activity commences as part of the wider 'Tour Briefing' which commonly precedes all tours, activities and excursions
- On the tour vehicle as it approaches the destination or as it is parked in the agreed parking area for the tour, excursion or activity
- At an agreed muster point for the tour/activity which is inside or near the entry to the indigenous community.



Content of the briefing

Background

The content of the briefing will need to be prepared in consultation with the indigenous community in order to address their individual concerns and issues, and may need to be:

- Developed by the individual Tour Guide conducting the Tour, excursion or activity – as part of their preparation activities
- Developed by the Tour Operator – and be provided as part of the standard 'Tour Brief' to the Tour Guide/staff
- Have to gain 'final approval from the local community – prior to its implementation.

Generic topics

Issues commonly covered by these briefings include:

- Detailing where people can and cannot go/enter
- Specifying what they can do and say and what they *cannot* do and say
- Illustrating and ensuring adherence to required dress codes when in the area/community
- Describing and demonstrating protocols to observe when in a tour vehicle/riding an animal
- Naming actions to optimise group safety, comfort, engagement and enjoyment
- Identifying cultural issues which must be respected
- Nominating environmental issues which must be taken into account
- Stating social protocols which must be observed.

Examples of possible *specific* topics

Potentially worrying issues to individual indigenous are those which have been identified by the communities as being 'of concern' to them – and examples may include:

- Prohibiting access to certain areas – such as:
 - Not entering nominated buildings and/or grounds
 - Staying a certain distance from designated sites
 - Never going into private homes/dwellings
 - Avoiding contact with obvious family areas
 - Not wandering off designated tracks/walking paths
- Limiting the taking of photographs or video or other recordings – in relation to (for example):
 - Prohibiting images of indigenous people – or females, or children in the community
 - Banning recording images of designated sacred sites
 - Requiring permission before recording images
 - Asking if locals need payment to be photographed/recorded
- Controlling engagement with local people – in terms of:
 - Banning discussion with the general population – and limiting verbal exchanges only to local/indigenous Tour Guides and/or designated community people identified as being part of the tour group/staff
 - Not allowing offering of cash or gifts
 - Avoiding staring
 - Prohibiting eye contact
- Explaining and demonstrating appropriate interactions with local – which may address:
 - Initial contact/greeting – saying 'Hello'
 - Appropriate body language – and actions to avoid
 - Topics which can be discussed and which should be avoided
 - General conversation tips and words/phrases – such as saying 'Please' and 'Thank you'
- Focussing on resources/items taken into a community – with reference to (for example):
 - Insisting all resources/items taken into a community are taken out – and no rubbish is left behind as a result of the tour, excursion or activity
 - Banning carriage of certain products into a community – such as disposable nappies, plastic bags, fast food, bottles



- Designating items which can and cannot be removed from the community – which may address:
 - Banning removal of food, flora and fauna from the area
 - Stressing only merchandise purchased from the locals can be removed
- Stressing the need to conserve (and/or *not use at all*) local and limited resources – which may be:
 - Water/drinking water
 - Wood
 - Foodstuffs
- Describing action to take in relation to local flora and fauna – such as:
 - Not scaring animals
 - Not touching, patting or feeding local stock
 - Not picking flowers.



Websites

It is useful at this stage to visit:

<http://www.aippnet.org/index.php/human-rights/763-statement-of-indigenous-peoples-a-ethnic-minorities-ipaem-of-asean> - Statement of indigenous peoples and ethnic minorities (IP&EM) of ASEAN.

http://www.aippnet.org/pdf/ASEAN.%20CC.%20REDD+%20AND%20IPs_FINAL.pdf – ASEAN, Climate Change, REDD+and indigenous peoples.

2.4 Communicate general knowledge to tour groups

Introduction

A range of techniques can be used to communicate general knowledge on indigenous cultures to members of tour groups.

This section lists the primary approaches used to communicate this knowledge and identifies when this information may be shared.

Techniques for sharing

Ways to share general knowledge focus on the following options:

- Delivering verbal presentations – in terms of:
 - Formal, structured presentations
 - Casual, supplementary contributions
- Providing handout materials
- Using recorded presentations
- Making community visits
- Implementing interpretive activities.

Verbal presentations

These are usually:

- Formal, structured presentations – which:
 - Are provided to all tour group members for every tour, excursion or activity
 - Will be time-limited – in that they need to be completed in a set time so they do not take time from other aspects of the tour/activity
 - Have been developed before-hand and may have been approved by the destination communities
 - Are targeted to the individual community that is the focus of an up-coming tour/activity
 - Address topics relevant to the type and aim/objectives of the tour
 - Ensure 'required topics' as identified by the indigenous people are delivered and explained to the tour groups
 - May be supplemented by use of a PowerPoint, slide or overhead projection presentation
 - Could include distribution of handout materials and recorded information – see below
 - May feature demonstrations – to illustrate certain points deemed important/central to the tour/activity



- Casual, supplementary contributions – these are comments made by the Tour Guide and other tour staff:
 - In response to special requests raised by tour group members when on-tour
 - When answering on-tour questions asked by members of the tour group
 - While conversing with individuals or small groups while on-tour
- Scripted commentaries – these:
 - The pre-prepared/written scripts used when providing a tour commentary when on-tour
 - Differ to reflect the individual requirements of each tour type
 - Provide consistent general information to every tour group on every tour
 - Are sequenced to match sights and activities featured on the tour
 - Are based on significant research and input from relevant stakeholders including the indigenous community
 - Will be approved by the local community to ensure it is factual and truly reflective of their culture
- Unscripted commentaries – these are different to ‘Casual, supplementary contributions’ as described above in that they:
 - Add information about topics and issues as they arise on tour which are ‘over and above’ the content covered by the scripted commentary
 - Address ‘one-off’ instances observed by the group while on-tour
 - Factor in seasonal and unique events.

Handout materials

Handout materials which can disseminate general information to tour group members can include:

- Information sheets – giving basic information about the destination such as coverage of topics including:
 - History
 - Geographical features
 - Flora and fauna
 - Customs and beliefs
 - Social and family structures
 - Rites and religions
- Fact sheets – which may be produced to supplement and extend information on topics which provide a focus for individual tour types. These sheets – which will vary depending on the nature/type/title of the tour being conducted into the indigenous community – give ‘extra’ detail and insight on the individual headings/topics covered by the Information sheets
- Photographs, illustrations and drawings – relating to people, their community, their art, animals and a wide range of potential other topics. Once again the focus of these should reflect the nature, type or title of the tour as well as any known interests or special requests made by tour group members



- Sample items – this may involve:
 - Showing of indigenous artefacts
 - Tasting of local food and beverages
 - Distribution of examples of local work and art
- Interpretive activity sheets – these can:
 - Provide targeted information relevant only to specific interpretive activities to be conducted within the community as part of the planned itinerary for the tour
 - Give relevant background information to assist with understanding the context for each interpretive activity
 - Include observation (or ‘scoring’) sheets – for tour group members to record their findings, feelings, experiences and similar.



Recorded presentations

General information may also be shared using:

- A video/DVD which provides general information about the overall indigenous community and people – this video/DVD would be shown to all tour groups
- A range of sub-ordinate videos/DVDs – which provide information targeted to narrower elements/topics which will be addressed by certain tour types
- Electronic personal devices – provided to individual tour group members to enable them to conduct their own ‘self-briefings’
- A range of ‘images’ – which may be shared/communicated using:
 - Booklets and brochures
 - Individual photographs
 - PowerPoint presentations
- Audio recording – of language, singing, animals, natural events.

Community visits

The sharing of general information to tour group members always involves this critical aspect – where:

- Tour groups physically go into the community – to observe the people and the environment and engage with the land/community
- Customers interact with the indigenous communities – in-keeping with pre-arranged/allowed limits
- Tourists become immersed in the totality of the indigenous culture – and what it has to offer
- Tour group members engage with a range of interpretive activities – pre-prepared by the Tour Operator and approved and supported by the local community.

Interpretive activities

The interpretive approach to guiding can also be used to share general knowledge to tour groups.

Interpretive guiding:

- Can be seen as the use of interpretive activities and presentation techniques by a Tour Guide when leading/presenting a tour
- Makes a tour for participants a much more memorable experience
- Goes beyond the basic provision of information which is seen by many as their sole objective when conducting a tour
- Refers to the use of interpretive activities and techniques to interpret the topics/areas which are the focus of the tour or encountered along the way
- Seeks to make people care about, and care for, topics and subjects which are the focus of interpretive activities.

Relevant techniques which may be used for sharing general knowledge may feature the use of:

- Role playing
- Using different voice techniques
- Story-telling
- Playing of games
- Conducting activities
- Presenting demonstrations
- Delivering participant interaction situations
- Holding sensory awareness exercises
- Using materials to enhance illustration and experiences
- Utilising technology to assist with delivery.

Timing of communications

There are several standard times when general knowledge about an indigenous culture might be shared with tour groups. These times can generally be divided into three discrete sections:

- Pre-tour advice
- During-tour notification
- Post-tour communication.

Pre-tour advice

This sharing of general knowledge may occur:

- When tickets are provided to purchasers – in hard copy form by handing out Information Sheets and Fact Sheets
- At a pre-tour briefing – in a variety of ways such as:
 - Making a verbal presentation



- Screening a video/DVD
- Responding to questions
- Distributing and explaining Fact and Information Sheets
- Prior to arriving at or entering the destination community – such as:
 - While travelling in the tour vehicle to the community
 - While on the tour vehicle when it is parked at the entrance to the community
 - While gathered together at a designated muster point adjacent to the entrance to the community.

During-tour advice

This sharing of general knowledge may occur:

- While walking to the assembly point in the community
- While travelling in a tour vehicle within community lands
- At a pre-arranged location (a room/building) within the community – as part of a formal community-focussed briefing
- As part of the preparation for an interpretive activity – which requires certain general knowledge to be communicated in order to contextualise and provide necessary information to enable the activity to be conducted
- During the de-briefing which takes place at the conclusion of an interpretive activity – as part of the process of helping tour group members learn from their experience and assisting them to consider and digest what they have discovered.

Post-tour advice

This sharing of general knowledge may occur:

- On the tour vehicle as part of ‘general discussion’ as the tour group return to the departure point for the tour
- In a shared/common room at the accommodation venue at the end of the day – this occurs on a multi-day tour where the itinerary features a daily meeting/de-briefing session where Tour staff seek to:
 - Provide an overview of the day’s activities
 - Respond to questions
 - Capture feedback about the tour
- At the Tour Operator offices when the tour has concluded – as part of the end-of-tour procedures which may also include:
 - Distributing photographs from the tour – and other tour-related merchandise
 - Thanking the group
 - Obtaining feedback
 - Farewelling customers.



2.5 Reply to tour group questions on indigenous cultures

Introduction

There is always a need for Tour Guides to answer questions asked by tour group members.

This section provides general advice for responding to tour group questions, identifies specific considerations when replying to questions relating to indigenous cultures and presents advice on dealing with questions where the answers are not known.

Answering questions

Tips for answering questions asked as part of a tour include:

- Thank the person for the question – this encourages others to ask questions as it shows questions are actually welcomed
- Mention the person's name when thanking them – many tours issue name tags which can be used to identify who individuals are. This personalises the answer *and* people love to hear the sound of their own name
- Smile when responding – if appropriate – this is another way of showing providing answers to questions is not an imposition
- Use polite and respectful language – when replying, including the use of humour, where appropriate
- Provide a direct answer to the question which was asked – this means:
 - Giving a full, detailed, comprehensive and honest answer as relevant to the question
 - Not avoiding the question or re-directing or re-framing it
 - Being prepared to say “I’m sorry but I don’t know the answer to that question.” See below for more on this
- Ensure personal opinion in an answer is specifically identified as such – and not offered as fact
- Present the answers to the most appropriate ‘target’ – in some cases:
 - The answer is best given just to the person who asked the question
 - It is better to include the rest of the group in the response which is provided
- Respond promptly – taking care:
 - Never to rush the response
 - Not to appear curt
 - To not give the impression there are better things to be done



- Check the response has answered the question to satisfaction of the person who asked it – this can involve:
 - Encouraging another question
 - Enquiring if clarification is needed
 - Asking if illustration of a point is required.

Specific considerations

The following are all requirements when responding to tour group questions on indigenous cultures:

- Maintaining truthfulness at all times – in the content provided for all responses
- Imposing a total ban on fabrication of answers – if the answer to a question is not known: see below
- Respecting requests from communities – regarding:
 - Information that cannot be shared with the public
 - Details which are sensitive or confidential
- Putting answers into context – by (as appropriate):
 - Providing background and history relevant to the issue
 - Supplying detail to provide a framework for reference and/or comparison purposes
 - Raising additional issues which are related and relevant to the question
- Including local indigenous people (local Tour Guides, interpreters, presenters, assistants and similar) in the reply – in order to:
 - Provide a first-hand 'unfiltered' response from the local people
 - Show inclusivity and respect for the ability of the locals
 - Have them demonstrate an action as a physical response to the question.



Handling questions where the answer is not known

Where no protocols exist the following are useful techniques:

- Apologise for not knowing – this is a standard 'customer service' response and needs to be done. The apology needs to be genuine and accompanied by appropriate supporting body language/facial expressions
- Maintain positive relations with the person/group – it is important:
 - Not to show annoyance at not knowing the answer
 - Not to be personally embarrassed about the lack of knowledge
 - Not to give the person who asked the question the impression they should ask no more questions

- Give information on an *associated* topic – which:
 - May give some generally broad detail in relation to the actual question asked
 - At least shows a willingness to respond even though the real answer is not known
- Refer the question to the rest to someone else – this may be:
 - A local Tour Guide or community representative
 - To see if anyone else on the tour has an answer to the question
- Refer customers to sources that may provide the relevant information at the conclusion of the tour – this may be:
 - Brochures, posters, handouts which are available at the point of disembarkation
 - A website
 - A Visitor Information Centre
 - A business, organisation or government agency/authority
- Make arrangements to research the question – at the conclusion of the tour and:
 - Pass on the answer face-to-face at the point of disembarkation, if the person is willing to wait a few minutes
 - Send a reply via email to the person if they are able to provide an address
 - Give an SMS reply if they provide a number.



2.6 Monitor and respond to culturally inappropriate behaviour

Introduction

At all times when leading tours and interpretive activities within indigenous communities, Tour staff must be sensitive to the behaviour of tour group members.

This section discusses issues inherent in monitoring and responding to culturally inappropriate behaviour while on-tour in these communities and presents generic advice for handling problems with tour group members when on-tour.

Monitoring tour group behaviour

Monitoring the behaviour of tour group members when on-tour in indigenous communities will need to focus on:

- Watching the group – which means:
 - Seeing what people are doing
 - Noting where tour group members are going
 - Checking body language/non-verbal communications signals
- Listening to the group – in terms of:
 - What is said
 - How things are said
 - Tone and/or volume of voice used
- Receiving advice from others – in terms of:
 - Input from Tour staff
 - Advice from local representatives/members of the community
 - Other tour group members.



Note: it is SOP for Tour Guides to make sure they actually observe (that is, they themselves hear or see) the inappropriate behaviour before they respond to it.

Responding to culturally inappropriate behaviour

Keys for Tour Guides when responding to culturally inappropriate behaviour include:

- Reinforcing previously presented information on culturally sensitive and acceptable behaviour – as presented to the group during the briefing session/activity that preceded the tour
- Demonstrating culturally sensitive and acceptable behaviour – to help illustrate the point which needs to be made as part of the tour guiding process
- Responding promptly – issues must be addressed as soon as they are noticed because this:
 - Demonstrates the issue is important and is being taken seriously
 - Will send a message to all the tour group about what is unacceptable and inappropriate
 - Helps to better control/eliminate unacceptable and inappropriate behaviour

- Intervening as required/necessary – to (for example)
 - Asking tour group members to modify unacceptable behaviour
 - Asking people to refrain from certain actions
 - Demonstrating acceptable speech and/or actions
 - Illustrating requirements through verbal explanations/descriptions
- Warning the individuals or the group (as appropriate) of the consequences – if they persist with their unacceptable/inappropriate behaviour (or language)
- Being prepared to adjust the tour or an activity – as required by the nature, extent or seriousness of the unacceptable/inappropriate behaviour (or language), which may mean:
 - Modifying the content, location or duration of the tour or activity
 - Changing the focus/nature of the tour
 - Terminating an activity or visitation.

Handling problems with tour group members

Tips include:

- Realise no problem will ever resolve itself – problems require action to fix/address them
- Take responsibility for taking action – it is part of the job to do so
- All identified issues must be addressed – never simply ignore a problem
- Treat people with respect – talk politely with them allow them their dignity

Aim to make the other person feel special, not to feel victimised. Talk with people who need to be spoken to away from others in order to respect their right not to be embarrassed or challenged in front of others. Try to stay calm – when a need to intervene and say something to a participant arises: ‘act’ but do not ‘over-react’

- Avoid using a loud voice and try to speak so the conversation is private – and so the participant/s do not feel as if they are being reprimanded in front of the rest of the group and being made to look silly or ‘small’
- Phrase what is said so it is not a personal ‘attack’ on the other person – for example, instead of saying “You must not do that”, re-phrase the statement to “We prefer such action does not take place while here/on tour/in this location”
- Try phrasing statements as asking people to modify their behaviour as ‘requests’ – rather than ‘commands’ to do things. Give reasons why the request is being made – there is big difference between ‘Stop doing that’ and “Could I please ask you not to do that because it offends people in this community?”
- Look through the eyes of the tour group member and try to see things from their perspective. For example, consider saying “I understand you would like to get closer to XYZ but we have been asked to stay at a distance because the community have said they feel threatened if visitors get too close”.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project flows from Work Project 1.1 and forms the basis of the final Work Project for this Unit.

2.1 Using the indigenous community identified in the previous Work Project demonstrate you have shared information on that culture/community by providing anecdotal, photographic, electronic or other legitimate evidence you have:

- Communicated general knowledge to Tour Operator staff and/or Tour Guides and Tour staff
 - Determined how members of the indigenous community could be used as guides, interpreters or in other tour-related roles
 - Briefed tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with indigenous people
 - Communicated general knowledge to tour groups
 - Replied to tour group questions on indigenous cultures
 - Monitored and responded to culturally inappropriate behaviour.
-

Summary

Share information on indigenous cultures

When sharing information on indigenous cultures:

- Communicate general knowledge using a variety of mediums and approaches
- Focus on providing information to colleagues both internally and externally, on-site within communities
- Use indigenous people to assist with tours and activities
- Employ indigenous people in a range of primary and supporting roles
- Brief tour groups about acceptable and unacceptable behaviour within indigenous communities
- Advise tour group members regarding culturally-appropriate and inappropriate behaviour and language within indigenous communities
- Communicate relevant information in advance of and/or in conjunction with the tour/activity
- Give tourists general knowledge about local indigenous communities
- Supplement provision of general knowledge with specific/targeted information, as required
- Use a range of techniques to provide information to tour groups
- Involve people from the community in the provision of information
- Answer questions from the tour group honestly
- Respect cultural sensitivities and identified confidentialities when responding to questions
- Monitor behaviour and language of tour group members when they are in indigenous communities
- Respond promptly and effectively to culturally inappropriate behaviour and language of tour group members when interacting with indigenous communities.

Element 3: Maintain contact with local communities

3.1 Liaise with local communities to identify and respond to changed circumstances

Introduction

An effective and mutually beneficial relationship with a local community is based on maintaining regular contact/communication between the Tour Operator and the group or their representatives.

This section examines what is entailed in maintaining contact with local communities and presents actions a Tour Operator might take to demonstrate a willingness to liaise with a community in a meaningful way.

Maintaining contact

Maintaining contact with local communities will require the following three generic actions to be taken:

- Determining *how* and *when* the local community prefers to communicate – there may be a preference for:
 - Face-to-face meetings or electronic/telephone contact
 - Meetings in the local community or meetings at nominated other locations
 - Short casual meetings or more formal/structured meetings
 - Meetings with the community as a whole or meetings with nominated representatives
 - Frequent meetings or less-frequent but nonetheless scheduled meetings
- Keeping the lines of communication open – which can be optimised by:
 - Talking honestly
 - Being available when required
 - Returning calls
 - Being prepared to use a variety of different communication options
 - Using different communication methods for individual stakeholders
 - Being proactive in initiating contact
 - Communicating in the way/manner preferred by the local community
 - Being flexible in meetings times



- Maintaining and distributing hard copy information regarding information shared, decisions reached and arrangements which have been made
- Honouring promises that have been made – this is arguably the single biggest element in maintaining a positive relationship with a local community
- Actively monitoring the relationship – with a view to:
 - Obtaining feedback/input from relevant stakeholders
 - Creating opportunities for feedback from the community
 - Supplying the means and methods for providing feedback
 - Soliciting suggestions
 - Factoring in feedback from tour groups
 - Asking the community about the relationship and arrangements which have been made
 - Identifying and addressing small problems before they become big ones
 - Doing no harm – this must always be a primary priority in the relationship: no harm should come to the community, individuals in it, its reputations, its environment or anything to do with the people or their culture.

Liaising with local communities

Liaising with local community may involve or require:

- Keeping in regular contact with the local community to encourage communication – meaning:
 - Contact needs to occur even where there is ‘nothing special’ or something definite to be discussed
 - A schedule of meetings/contacts might be useful in providing a basis for contact
 - Making sure the local community has all contact details for the Tour Operator
 - Designating one (or two) dedicated people within the organisation for the local community to use as their target contacts
- Responding to community concerns – by, as appropriate/necessary:
 - Varying tours and activities to suit local community needs, wants and preferences
 - Varying tours and activities as a result of local ceremonies, rites, rituals and festivals
 - Varying tours and activities where any form of unacceptable impact on the community or the local environment has been observed
- Adjusting and/or removing activities and/or the provision of information to tour groups – as required:
 - On the basis of feedback from the local community
 - As the community provides additional information
 - Where the local community:
 - Authorises a change in the release of information to the public
 - Wants a change in the type/detail of information given to tourists



- Suggesting and/or assisting with the development of new tours and/or activities – on the basis of:
 - Mutually beneficial opportunities which may present themselves
 - Ideas and proposals put forward by the local community are developed with the local community
- Responding appropriately to any examples where tourist activity is having a negative impact on the local community – this needs to embrace:
 - Assisting the community take whatever ‘other action’ is necessary to address the issue/s – such as legal action, educational campaigns, engagement with authorities, security or protective action
 - Willingness to cancel tours – and return payments/deposits to customers
 - Ability to alter promotional material to reflect changed conditions/circumstances.

3.2 Modify information provided in accordance with issues raised by the local community

Introduction

For communication and liaison with local communities to be truly meaningful, Tour Operators need to be prepared to modify information provided to tour group members in response to issues raised.

This section gives a context for changes which may need to be made and identifies suggestions/possibilities for modifications to information which may be required.

Orientation to changes

The Tour Operator must adopt the following orientations to the potential need to modify information provided to the public/tour group members:

- Proving a willingness to vary information provided to suit local community needs – via verbal and non-verbal language/cues
- Being receptive to suggestions for change – including suggestions to reduce or extend existing arrangements
- Taking prompt action (see below) on the basis of comment/input from the community – as opposed to delaying and deferring changes
- Doing what needs to be done without complaining – and without making the community feel as if their requests/requirements are an imposition
- Not challenging the changes which are required/requested – but accepting the changes which are identified as being necessary
- Showing the local community new materials/commentaries which have been produced – so they can see the positive response of the Tour Operator
- Seeking approval from the community – for the changes which are made before they are adopted.



Items which may need to be altered

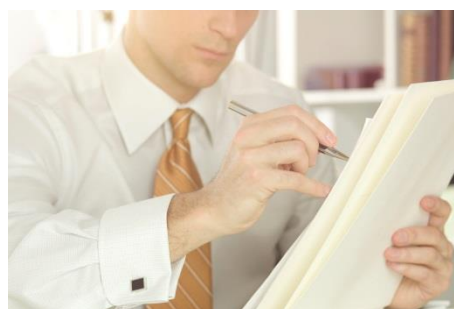
This information may need to be modified in relation to:

- Advertisements and promotions for tours and interpretive activities
- Material included in hard copy handouts supplied to tour group members
- Scripted commentaries prepared for tours and activities
- Comments/unscripted commentary provided by Tour Guides and tour staff
- Advice and detail used to explain, describe and/or demonstrate an interpretive activity.

Possible modifications to information provided

The following are practical actions and changes which may need to be made to information to be provided to tour group members:

- Reviewing existing materials – to determine:
 - The exact items which need to be changed
 - Nature and extent of changes needed
- Liaise with local communities – to:
 - Clarify issues surrounding required changes
 - Confirm required changes
 - Seek help with making the required changes
 - Gain approval for the changes which have been made
- Revising/re-writing items to reflect modifications required – in terms of:
 - Advertisements
 - Promotional brochures and posters
 - Handouts provided as part of the tour and/or tour briefing sessions
 - Sheets distributed as part of interpretive activities
 - Scripted commentaries
 - Agreements/contracts between Tour Operator and local communities
- Removing items from circulation – which may entail:
 - Taking brochures and advertising materials from racks and locations in which they have been placed
 - Taking material off the website
 - Removing materials as required from pre-prepared kits/folders
 - Updating version control protocols – to ensure the most current version is the one used in the future



- Correcting text and/or script – with references to issues such as:
 - Mistakes
 - Spelling
 - Grammar
 - Omissions
- Updating internal training – so that:
 - Training (role plays, drills, practical sessions) uses current/up-dated materials
 - Staff gain experience and competency with the new information
- Keeping previously disclosed information secret – in relation to:
 - Not taking tour group members into places/areas that are now restricted
 - Not making unscripted comments about information which is now prohibited
- Altering scheduled itineraries and activities – on the basis of:
 - Feedback received from the local community
 - Changed priorities of the community
 - Concerns raised
- Up-dating facts and figures relating to the local community – regarding (for example):
 - Population numbers
 - Employment rates
 - Crime
 - Achievements
- Applying another method of communication/transmission of information – which may mean:
 - Using a Tour Guide/presenter from the local community
 - Speaking in a different language/local language
 - Presenting the same information via (say):
 - Printed word instead of the spoken word
 - An activity as opposed to (just) information
 - Remote presentation rather than communication in the community.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project flows from the previous Work Projects for this Unit.

3.1 Using the indigenous community identified as the basis for previous Work Projects demonstrate maintenance of contact with them providing evidence you have:

- Liaised with them to identify and respond to changed circumstances
 - Modified information provided in accordance with issues raised by the local community.
-

Summary

Maintain contact with local communities

When maintaining contact with local communities:

- Realise the importance and ongoing need for regular contact
- Determine and follow the contact and communication preferences of the community
- Be proactive and initiate contact
- Invite input and feedback
- Provide necessary resources to enable contact and communication
- Monitor the strength and quality of the relationship
- Develop a schedule of meetings
- Respond to community concerns
- Assist with community ideas and initiatives
- Be willing to make changes to information in accordance with wishes of local communities
- Ensure all relevant materials are amended to reflect required changes made by local communities
- Use version control protocols to control changes made to hard copy information
- Alter internal training to mirror required changes to information made by local communities
- Obtain approval from local communities regarding required changes made to information provided.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Note: all Recommended Reading is sourced from 'Trove: National Library of Australia' at <http://trove.nla.gov.au/>.

ASEAN Tourism Forum (2011: Phnom Penh, Cambodia) and Cambodia. Krasuari Descarņ ASEAN: *a world of wonders and diversity: treasure trove of cultures and heritage in a multi-faceted single destination*. Phnom Penh, Cambodia designed and published by Red (Cambodia) Dot under the supervision of the Ministry of Tourism of the Kingdom of Cambodia, 2011.

Chon, Kaye Sung 2013, *Tourism in Southeast Asia A New Direction*, Taylor and Francis, Hoboken.

ISEAS 2010, *Know Your ASEAN 2nd Edition*, 2nd ed, Institute of Southeast Asian Studies (ISEAS), Singapore

Payne, Richard J 2014, *Global issues*, Fourth edition, Pearson new international edition, Harlow, Essex Pearson Education Limited.

Princi, Lauren 2008, *The first people: indigenous cultures of the world*, Ready-ed Publications, Greenwood, WA.

Scupin, Raymond 2016, *Cultural anthropology: a global perspective*, Ninth edition, Hoboken, NJ Pearson Education.

Sissons, Jeffrey 2005, *First peoples: indigenous cultures and their futures*, Reaktion Books, UK: U of Chicago Press, Great Britain.

Ward, Graeme, 1943- & Smith, Claire, 1957- & James Bennett Pty. Ltd 2003, *Indigenous cultures in an interconnected world*, Allen & Unwin, Crows Nest, N.S.W

Weightman, Barbara A 2011, *Dragons and tigers: a geography of South, East and Southeast Asia*, 3rd ed, Wiley, Hoboken, NJ.

Trainee evaluation sheet

Research and share information on indigenous cultures

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Research and share information on indigenous cultures

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Research information on indigenous cultures			
1.1	Identify sources of information on indigenous cultures	☐	☐
1.2	Research and interpret sources of information	☐	☐
1.3	Demonstrate respect for indigenous people and their culture(s)	☐	☐
1.4	Determine how information on indigenous cultures should be used	☐	☐
Element 2: Share information on indigenous cultures			
2.1	Communicate general knowledge to colleagues	☐	☐
2.2	Use indigenous guides and/or interpreters where possible	☐	☐
2.3	Brief tour groups regarding appropriate behaviour when interacting with indigenous people	☐	☐
2.4	Communicate general knowledge to tour groups	☐	☐
2.5	Reply to tour group questions on indigenous cultures	☐	☐
2.6	Monitor and respond to culturally inappropriate behaviour	☐	☐
Element 3: Maintain contact with local communities			
3.1	Liaise with local communities to identify and respond to changed circumstances	☐	☐
3.2	Modify information provided in accordance with issues raised by the local community	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

